

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St. Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur

'Make entry point to this overpass in Pallavaram safe'

R. ASHA RAVI

On a stretch of GST Road in Pallavaram, there is an urgent need to lay speed breakers near the entry point of the flyover towards Chromepet.

Near the overpass, information and signage boards have been put up for motorists heading towards Chromepet, Madipakkam, Vela-

chery Main Road and the IT Corridor.

Due to the lack of speed breakers, motorists fail to notice the boards in time and swerve suddenly to access the overpass.

As motorists come at high speed this can cause multiple collisions. Similarly, at times, it appears that motorists will enter the flyover, then take a sudden left onto GST Road. This movement is fraught

with danger for other motorists.

Speed breakers will slow down motorists, and they should be laid here for the safety of road users.

Recently, three accidents happened here. The lane is relatively free, unlike the western lane (towards Pallavaram junction), where traffic is slow-moving.

More Readers Write on Page 3



Chromepet witnessed a moment of pride, elegance, and distinction as Little Elly Preschool and the second branch of Kalpavriksha School of Natya at chromepet were graciously inaugurated by Dr. C. Sylendra Babu, IPS (Retd.), Former Director General of Police and Head of Police Force, Tamil Nadu.

Adding a unique dimension to the occasion, the event also transformed into a prestigious police reunion, as Mr. Vijayakumar V., (late) Retired Deputy Superintendent of Police, and Mrs. V. Venkatamma, Retired Sub-Inspector of Police—parents of Ms. Lakshmi Vijay—brought together a distinguished gathering of retired Inspectors, Deputy Inspectors General (DIGs), and esteemed members of the police fraternity.



nity. Their presence elevated the inauguration into a celebration of service, legacy, and community.

This new center stands as a benchmark in early childhood education, redefining standards with a truly premium, European-inspired infrastructure—a rarity in the locality. Every detail of the

campus has been meticulously curated, featuring elegant interiors, child-centric learning environments, Montessori-based classrooms, and thoughtfully designed activity zones, creating a nurturing and inspiring space for young learners.

At the helm is Ms. Lakshmi Vijay, an accomplished

Bharatanatyam artiste and educator, and a prime disciple of Guru Padma Bhushan Dr. Shobana Chandrakumar. With her deep-rooted commitment to classical arts and education, she has infused the institution with a harmonious blend of traditional values and contemporary learning methodologies.

Ms. Lakshmi Vijay is also the Artistic Director of Kalpavriksha School of Natya, a reputed institution with eight branches across Chennai, mentoring over 500 students in the classical art of Bharatanatyam. Recently, Kalpavriksha School of Natya celebrated its 10th Annual Day with great pride, where



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the students performed with grace, discipline, and remarkable perfection in every step with orchestra team

The integration of Little Elly's globally recognized preschool framework with Kalpavriksha's strong artistic heritage makes this center truly distinctive. It is not merely a preschool, but a refined ecosystem where education, culture, and creativity converge seamlessly. This inauguration marks the beginning of a new chapter in premium education in Chromepet, setting a high standard for excellence in both early childhood learning and classical arts training.

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▼
Bharathipuram burial ground lacks basic infrastructure including signages. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Adding to the distress of the bereaved

Residents and activists seek transparency in documentation, fee structure and authorisation at traditional burial grounds in Tambaram Corporation limits

T. ARVIND

Families belonging to Hindu communities that continue the practice of burial instead of cremation under the Tambaram Corporation limits are facing difficulties due to the absence of clear procedures and publicly available information at traditional burial grounds, residents and activists have alleged.

While the Tambaram Corporation has been encouraging the use of electric and gasifier crematoriums, activists say there is little clarity on the functioning of traditional burial and cremation grounds where manual methods are still followed.

Transparency sought

Senior social activist V. Santhanam said that though a majority of Hindus opt for cremation, some caste groups continue to follow burial customs. Facilities equipped with electric and gasi-



fier technology are functioning below the MIT flyover on GST Road and at Hasthinapuram.

However, traditional burial grounds lack basic information such as the name and contact details of caretakers, fee structure and mandatory documentation, he alleged.

“There is no transparency on who is in charge of the burial grounds or whether a doctor’s certificate is mandatory, as followed in crematoriums,” he said.

Santhanam urged the Tambaram Corporation to install boards mentioning the authorised caretaker, contact details, charges and documents required for burial or cremation. He also said caretakers at traditional facilities should be brought under the Corporation’s rolls and entrusted with maintaining registers and issuing receipts similar to procedures followed at gasifier crematoriums.

Grounds in poor condition

According to activists, traditional burial grounds at Bharathipuram and Ganapathipuram remain poorly maintained, without proper nameboards, security or public information. A similar facility is also functioning near Chitlapakkam Lake.

A resident recalled that a family from Tiruneermalai recently faced difficulties while attempting to bury a relative due to confusion over submission of a doctor’s certificate.

An official said that in cases of deaths occurring at home, sanitary officials are required to inspect the premises and verify the cause of death, while procedures differ in hospital-related deaths.

Call for regulation

R. Ramadas, advocate and social activist, alleged that there was neither a proper fee structure nor mandatory insistence on doctor’s certificates at the Bharathipuram burial ground, where both traditional burial and firewood-based cremation are carried out.

“The caretakers traditionally inherit the work and survive on payments made by visitors, as they are not formally paid by the Corporation,” he said.

Activists warned that the absence of due process could result in improper maintenance of death records, thereby affecting official data and welfare planning.

A sanitary officer said that when the local body functioned as a municipality, caretakers were directly monitored and authorised. “After Tambaram became a Corporation, the practice gradually stopped,” the official said.

Activists said maintaining proper records, authorised caretaker details and transparent fee structures at burial grounds was important to ensure transparency and prevent misuse, especially amid concerns over illegal activities in certain localities.

Fencing along Perungalathur railway tracks sought

Commuters and pedestrians continue undertaking dangerous railway track crossings near Perungalathur station, prompting residents to demand fencing and safer access routes



T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Residents of New Perungalathur-Peerkankaranai (East) regions have requested Southern Railway to fence the areas along the tracks near Perungalathur railway station and at Peerkankaranai.

At present, around three areas need to be fenced: one along Srinivasa Nagar First Cross Street, Peer-

kankaranai; and at the ends of Tholkappiyar Street and Manimegalai Street in Srinivasa Nagar, New Perungalathur.

Commuters and pedestrians from Srinivasa Nagar First Cross Street, Tholkappiyar Street, Tholkappiyar First Street, Brindavan Street, Sivagami Street, Amman Kovil Street, Surat Amman Kovil First Street and Kalaignar Nedunchalai

Extension either cross the tracks along Srinivasa Nagar First Cross Street or at the end of Tholkappiyar Street, to go to Old GST Road and GST Road in Irumbuliyur-Peerkankaranai.

People from Valayapathi Street, Silapathikaram Street, Navalur Street, K.K. Nagar Sixth Cross Street, Pallikoodam Street, Manimegalai Street, Nalayini Street and Gokulam Street cross the tracks at

the end of Manimegalai Street to go to Old GST Road, GST Road and the station.

J. Stephenson, a resident, says commuters and pedestrians should walk through K. K. Nagar High Road, Kalaignar High Road, Gokulam Street, and Thiruvalluvar Street to reach the station, and then use station subway to access GST Road, Old GST Road and Perungalathur haltovers.

“But to avoid walking the extra distance, commuters risk crossing the tracks. It has become a thoroughfare, with pedestrians traversing it from morning to night.”

K. Pushpa, another resident, says the areas along the tracks are

stony, uneven and littered with trash. During the rains, the pathway becomes slippery and remains risky. Yet, commuters and pedestrians continue to negotiate it. The problem becomes more pronounced after sunset, when there is no illumination while crossing the tracks.

Pedestrians and commuters from Old GST Road, GST Road, the city and regions along GST Road, from Chettipuniyam onwards, should use the subway. But only a section of the people do so. Many continue to cross the tracks through these areas.”

B. Senthil Kumar, a resident, says, “I have warned people not to cross the tracks. People do not listen. The people speak on the phones and among themselves.

“From Manimegalai Street, commuters cross the tracks to reach GST Road, Peerkankaranai, and Old GST Road, and walk along and on the tracks to reach the station. The problem has persisted for many days, and the railway should fence the open areas along the tracks to avoid loss of lives.”



Residents of Tholkappiyar Street say that pedestrians cross the tracks through this area to go to Old GST Road and GST Road. Photo: Special Arrangement — THE HINDU

READERS WRITE

‘Make Mappedu Cross Road safe for road users’

BEENA ANIL

The Mappedu Cross Road is unsafe for road users to negotiate. Despite heavy pedestrian and vehicular traffic, this junction has neither traffic signals nor a zebra crossing. Motorists are seen speeding, putting pedestrians at risk of accidents.

The authorities concerned should install a functional timed signal and demarcate a proper zebra crossing to ensure pedestrian safety. Speed breakers should be laid wherever necessary.

Beena Anil is a resident of Thiruvancheri



‘Install a new nameboard’



D SWAMINATHAN

It has been about two decades since Senthil Avenue Second Street was painted on a concrete stone that has gone to ground level. Ward Number 39 is not visible on the stone.

Tamparam City Municipal Corporation should take steps to facilitate the installation of a new street name board on the stretch.

‘Signboard at key junction is misleading’

S.N. RAJARAM

The image shows the signboard near the flyover at the junction of Porur-Kundrathur Main Road and Arcot Road on Mount-Poonamallee High Road in Porur. It faces motorists coming in from Guindy.

This signboard is incomplete and can be misleading for someone new to this area. Though the directional arrows for Kundrathur, Mouliwakkam, Vadapalani and Kodambakkam are correct, it does not mention that one has to take the service road under the flyover.

This gives room for ambiguity. Vanagaram tollgate (also known as Porur tollgate) and Poonamallee which are important points in the vicinity do not find a mention in the signboard near the Porur flyover.

S.N. Rajaram is a resident of Saligramam



‘Cool hands’ scarce in Chennai

With the mercury shooting up, calls for AC repair experts abound, and many of them go unanswered. A case for making AC technician courses more attractive to youngsters



LIFFY THOMAS

As summer temperatures spike in Chennai, air-conditioner technicians are working overtime, with households and businesses scrambling to install, repair and service cooling systems.

All major service providers note that they are struggling to meet the spurt in demand.

That wheels in a question: is the market being fed with a steady pool of trained AC technicians?

Sundaresan Ranganathan, director, Tamilnadu Advanced Technical Training Institute (TAT-TI), a registered organisation, says the Tamil Nadu Industrial Training Institute started offering a two-year programme in Mechanical Refrigeration and AC in 1985 but the course was discontinued during the pandemic due to poor intake.

Scaled-down versions of the same programme are being offered now, one with a three-month duration, and the other six months, but both struggle to inject sufficient trained technicians into the talent pool.

Polytechnic colleges and service providers have been adapting to attract and retain students and skilled technicians but they



At Ramakrishna Mission Polytechnic College's lab.

have been facing many obstacles. Ramakrishna Mission Polytechnic College in Mylapore, managed by Ramakrishna Mission Students' Home, runs a free residential diploma programme, affiliated to Directorate of Technical Education. At the end of every semester, the college management offers additional training for their students with its training partners, refrigeration and AC course being one of them.

M. Sugumaran, principal of the College, says students are more drawn towards the automobile and manufacturing sector, followed by product design and as developers in the technology sector.

“Diploma students are not so keen on being a technician, preferring to enter the field in supervisory roles for the three-year programme they studied,” says Sugumaran. He says unlike in the past students there have many other alternative courses that show equal, if not greater promise, so becoming a HVAC technician has lost its charm.

Many such institutions admitted students who completed Class X or Class XII; or even dropouts.

According to a report by Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW) titled ‘Formalising Air Conditioner Technician Training and Certification in India for Climate-resilient Servicing’, the demand for skilled room air-conditioner technicians will rise to around 2 million by 2036-37.

The servicing sector can play a significant role in helping deal with refrigerant overuse for servicing, and bring operational energy-efficiency closer to the designed benchmarks.

For a ready pool of trained technicians, the curriculum offered at most ITI institutions needs a revision. The report says that content must be co-created with industry participation and updated periodically to respond to changes on account of the refrigerant and technology transitions.

In addition to technical training, focus should also be on imparting entrepreneurial and soft skills such as communication and interpersonal skills. Offering social security to informal AC technicians are among other ways to draw people to the HVAC field.

Role of service providers

From incentives to career opportunities, major service providers are adopting different strategies to retain qualified talent.

Hitachi Engineering Excellence Centre runs training programmes to upskill AC technicians with the latest in the field. Its monthly training programmes conducted at SRM Easwari Engineering College in Ramapuram has employees from its 60-plus franchise partners in Tamil Nadu taking part in it.

Besides a skill development centre that Bluestar operates in Ambattur, it runs a training programme on wheels that goes to the doorsteps of the dealers to train technicians in the latest technologies.

Thirst aids for strays

From water bowls placed for thirsty stray animals to coconut shell feeders designed for urban birds, here are two organisations in Chennai finding simple, sustainable ways to help the city's voiceless residents endure the summer



SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

As temperatures rise in Chennai during May, the thirst for kindness rises with it. More than ever, the voiceless residents need acts of human kindness to get through their days. A bowl with water or feed is just what the doctor has ordered for animals and birds that are not pets, and have to fend for themselves through the year; and find regular sources of sustenance dry up during peak summer.

Besant Memorial Animal Dispensary (BMAD) in Besant Nagar is step-

ping up once again with its free community water bowl initiative. In its fourth year, the initiative distributes cement water bowls free of cost to residents, community feeders and animal lovers keen on placing them outside homes and shops and in street corners.

The organisation procures the bowls through donations and sponsors, sourcing them from local nurseries and suppliers before distributing them across the city. This year, BMAD initially procured 150 bowls, all of which were claimed within two days.

“We started this because animals

on the streets simply have nowhere to access water,” says Neeraja Venkateswaran, Head of Operations at BMAD. “Natural waterbodies have disappeared or become inaccessible because of urban development. What happens then is that these animals end up suffering from dehydration, heat strokes, and many of them do not survive something as basic as the unavailability of water.”

Where kindness swells, strangely, challenges abound. The logistics is daunting, observes Neeraja.

“And sometimes people ask for larger numbers, but we have to make sure



Bowls kept ready for distribution at BMAD in Besant Nagar.

everyone gets access fairly. Right now, we are distributing a maximum of one bowl per person. We have now placed another order for 400 more.”

The larger concern lies not in distribution, but maintenance. A neglected water bowl can quickly become unhygienic in Chennai's summer heat.

“People should ensure that the water is changed regularly because stagnant water becomes a breeding ground for mosquito larvae,” Neeraja explains. “And if larger animals like cows or horses come there often, it is better to create a permanent water trough because the cement bowls can break.”

The water bowls can be picked up from the BMAD office from Monday to Saturday between 09:30 a.m. and 12:00 p.m., and again from 02:30 p.m. to 04:00 p.m.

Beyond the bowls themselves, Neeraja believes there are countless small acts that can help animals survive the season. These include offering simple meals such as vegetable broth or chicken broth mixed with leftover rice; creating shaded spaces for animals to rest during peak afternoon heat; if possible, allow community dogs to sit inside gated areas or verandahs for some time during extremely hot afternoons.

For further details, BMAD can be contacted via the official email ID: admin.bmadts@gmail.com. They can also be reached through their official Instagram and Facebook handle: @besantmemorialanimaldispensary.

A coconut bowl crafted for feathered residents



A coconut shell bird feeder workshop was organised by Thuvakkam on May 9 at the NGO's head office in Valasaravakkam, bringing together constituencies across demographic divides. The exercise splices urban bird care and sustainable living.

The workshop introduced participants to the process of converting discarded coconut shells into eco-friendly bird feeders.

“Our main aim is to make sure every terrace has an eco-friendly bird feeder so that birds can also survive during summer,” says Kodama Durga Prasad, executive associate – Programs and Volunteering. He added, “Those who do not have space to hang it on their terrace can make use of the urban forests around the city.”

A DIY project

- Take a dry coconut shell and remove all

the inside flesh

- Wash and sun-dry it completely
- Smooth the edges using sandpaper so it is safe for birds
- Make 2-3 small holes near the rim using a drill or heated nail
- Pass jute rope or strong string through the holes and tie secure knots
- Create a loop at the top for hanging
- Optional: Add a small stick across the shell as a perch
- Fill it with millets, rice grains, broken wheat or sunflower seeds
- Avoid salty, spicy or cooked food
- Hang it in a shaded and safe place away from cats
- Refill food regularly and clean the shell once a week to maintain hygiene



During a coconut shell feeder-making session.



sundaravel / Feb 2

Birds read invisible maps

On World Migratory Bird Day, here is a case study of the Common pochard, exploring possible reasons why this bird could be 'warming up to' birders in the Chennai Metropolitan Area but giving those in Madurai the cold shoulder

PRINCE FREDERICK

"Not even time for birds to fly to southern skies." That is a line from Stevie Wonder's "I Just Called To Say I Love You", a song that has stood the shifting fads of time. And that line refers to an avian pattern that has persisted through time. It hints at birds migrating from the north, escaping its inclement winter to sojourn in the south. While the escape will continue winter after winter, the sojourn can undergo changes of address, depending on local factors, anthropogenic and climatic.

Welcome to the choices made by migratory birds: the how and

Common pochards at Amoor Lake near Chennai in February 2026.
PHOTOS: SUNDARAVEL PALANIVEL

why of it.

Dr. T. Badri Narayanan is an ophthalmologist with an eye for birds, an eye sharpened with some degree of formal training (a correspondence course from Bombay Natural History Society and an ornithology course offered by NPTEL during the pandemic) but largely on account of time spent on the field. He illustrates the possible causes of change in bird migration with his observations of the Common pochard in the Chennai Metropolitan Area and his regular stomping ground, Madurai.

Dr. Narayanan notes that the migratory Common pochard is sighted sporadically in the Chennai Metropolitan Area which includes patches of Kancheepuram and Chengalpet. It is also documented from time to time in other parts of southern Tamil Nadu. He recalls sightings of Common pochard flocks around 15 years ago at Aarpakkam tank near Kancheepuram as well as Ponnur lake, also set in the same geography. During the 2025-26 migratory season, the Common pochard showed up as a flock at Amoor lake, near Sirudhavar in Chengalpet district, not too far from Chennai.

In contrast, birders in Madurai are being stood up by this bird.

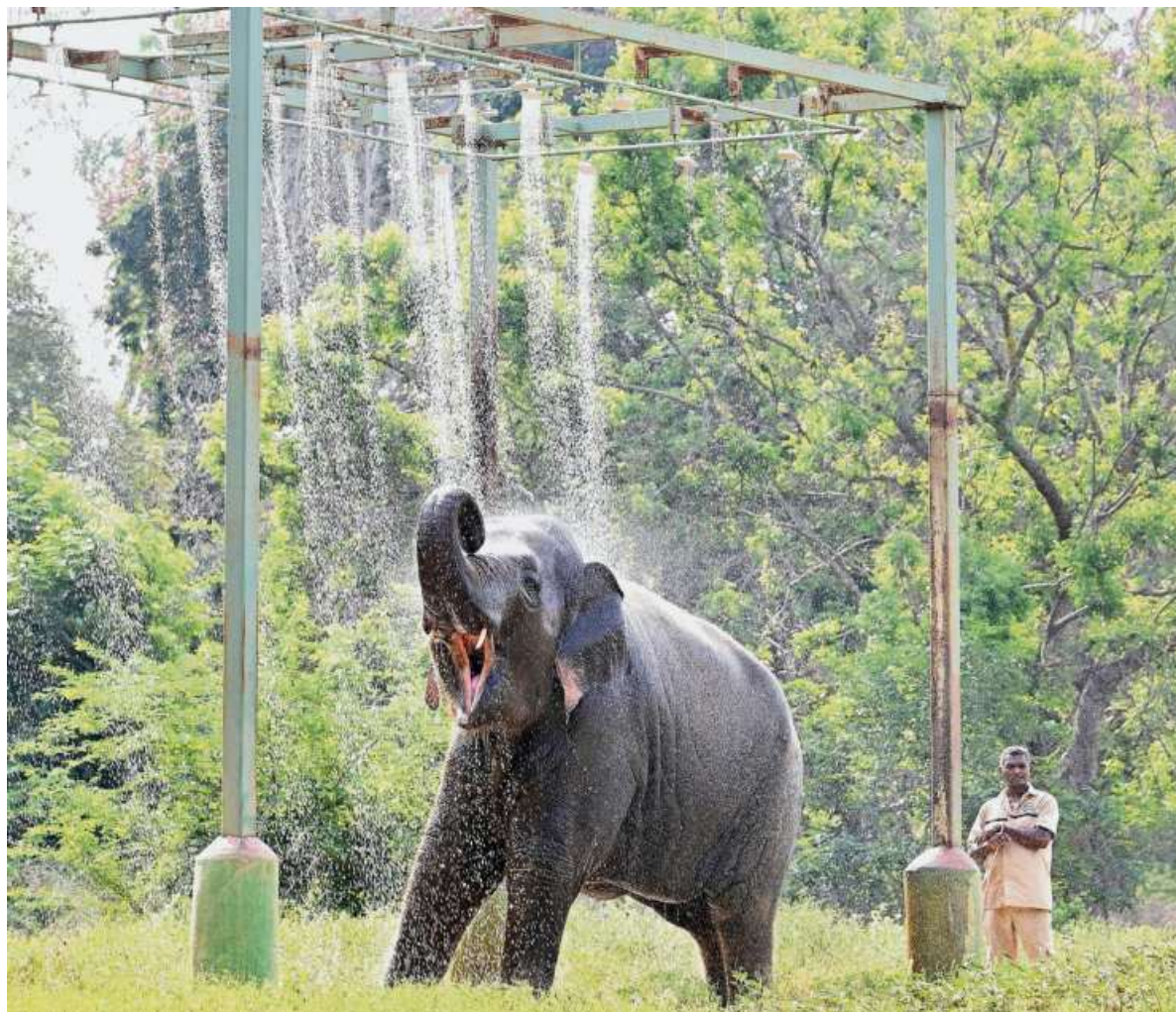
For anyone who has birded in the 1980s and 90s, this could be startling as Madurai was a sure-fire destination in this bird's winter itinerary. Dr. Badri Narayanan notes that a species can change its wintering address if it is up against habitat degradation. The reality in Madurai does not point in that direction, at least not on the surface, and he looks elsewhere for a possible cause.

He observes that globally, the Common pochard's numbers are dwindling and the species has moved from "Least Concern" to "Near Threatened", and therefore, fewer birds migrate deep into peninsular India. The suggestion is that they could be happily "hot-desked" with enough "seats" provided for them in the wetlands of central and northern India.

A migratory bird might change its wintering address for one or a combination of these reasons. One, habitat destruction. Two, food scarcity. Three, climatic changes. Four, population decline reducing migratory spread (the Common pochard's situation in Madurai probably checks this box). Five, availability of suitable habitats earlier on in their migratory route. Dr. Badri Narayanan notes that a cause can be identified only with sufficient data gathered over a long period of time with observations, around 10 years or more. He points out that citizen-science platforms such as eBird can be source for that kind of data.



Staying cool in Vandalur



As temperatures continue to climb, animal keepers at Arignar Anna Zoological Park in Vandalur can be seen carrying out summer management measures to help captive animals cope with heat stress. Sprinkler systems have been set up across enclosures housing elephants, rhinoceroses, hippopotamuses, chimpanzees and other animals. These sprinklers are operated multiple times through the day to reduce ambient temperatures and maintain moisture levels inside enclosures. Elephants are given regular showers and allowed to wallow in muddy ponds every day, while primates and bears are provided frozen fruits and meat to help regulate body temperature. Given their biological differences, a slightly different heat-management strategy would obviously be followed for birds. PHOTO: VELANKANNI RAJ B

A night of innovation and grit

More than 60 teams were shortlisted for Saveetha Engineering College's overnight hackathon

Recently, the campus of Saveetha Engineering College was buzzing with a sea of students, despite the night having set in.

The college tech society hosted 'HackHustle 2.0', an overnight hackathon, bringing together the brightest young minds from Tamil Nadu for the event that was as much about endurance as it was about technology.

Mohanbabu Balachandran, technology head and vice-president, Rocket India, inaugurated the event and shared practical insights on product development, system design, and user experience.

Of the 4,500 applications received for the event, more than 60 teams were shortlisted through a rigorous selection process that included PSG College of Technology, Sri Sairam Engineering College, Rajalakshmi Engineering College, Sathyabama Institute of Science and Technology and B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute, said a release.



During the event.

The teams competed across three critical battlefields: fintech, healthcare, and logistics.

As the clock ticked past 10:30 p.m., teams reached their first major milestone – a formal checkpoint review. Each team presented its progress, outlined implementation status and discussed challenges.

Organising committee members, deployed in pairs across all three ve-

nues, provided on-the-spot feedback to help teams course-correct.

Throughout the night, participants continued working. By early morning, a final round of faculty mentoring occurred.

Faculty members worked closely with teams to refine solutions and strengthen final presentations.

The hackathon was not merely a contest but a platform to nurture problem-solving and endurance.

The participants earned not just competition results, but lasting value in the form of experience, and the memory of a night defined by complete dedication, added the release.

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Event in Gowrivakkam

The 'Punaravarthana Mandalabhisheka Vishwa Shanthi Mahotsavam' of Varasiddhi Vinayakar and Panchamukha Anjaneyar Thirukovil in Gowrivakkam, will be held on May 10.

The ceremony will begin

with 'Thirumanjanam' at 8.30 a.m., followed by 'Shanthi Homam' at 10.30 a.m., and 'Maha Poornahathi' at 11.30 a.m.

For details, contact S. Ramachandran at 94440 420 55.

Textile exhibition in Pallavaram



Kalaa Utsavam, a textile expo featuring a range of home decor and jewellery, is on in Pallavaram till May 17.

A variety of handicrafts,

oxidised jewellery, men's footwear, artistic wall hangings, terracotta dolls, ready-made blouses, Kashmiri, Kanchipuram, and Karaikudi sarees, block-print sarees, churidar materials from Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, and Maharashtra, and flowering plants are on sale.

The expo is held at Arul Murugan Towers, located on 200-Foot Pallavaram-Thorai-pakkam Radial Road, Perumal Nagar, from 11 a.m. to 9 p.m.

For details, call 95660 55040, 79049 89326.

Songs from 'Versatile Asha'

Satrangi's next presentation 'Versatile Asha' will be held on May 10 from 5:45 p.m. at TEACH Auditorium, Taramani. This programme will feature memorable songs of the iconic singer Asha Bhonsle from movies like *Mere Sa-*

nam, Don, Chhoti Si Baat, Jawani Diwani, Umrao Jaan, Ijaazat, Yaadon Ki Baaraat, Kashmir Ki Kali, Hum Dono and Waqt. Tickets for this event are priced at ₹500 and ₹300 and will be home delivered on calling 9884778073.



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Velachery school kids steer road users **towards safety**

DAV School in Velachery is among institutions that have bagged a gold medal for activities taken under National Road Safety Mission for Schools



LIFFY THOMAS

A road safety rally resonating with slogans is a great way to raise awareness about the issue. And when conducted outside the school gates involving children, the effect can be arresting. DAV School in Velachery has done just that seeking to instil responsible road behaviour among citizens.

The school recently won the National Road Safety Education Excellence Awards 2025-26 in the gold

category, instituted by the National Road Safety Mission for Schools, a nationwide, collaborative, non-government initiative led by Academia Axis Edtech, International Road Federation (IRF) India Chapter and Eduxa.ai.

Uma S, supervisory head, DAV School, says organising a road safety rally around the school was challenging as it involves getting permission from the police and taking a lot of precautionary measures, but people on the road take note as children steer these exercises.

Putting up a message board at the school struck a cord with many visiting the campus. Students made an imprint of the message and displayed it. Messages include insisting that the parent wear a helmet even when the journey covers a short distance.

"We spoke to students to find that many had posted a message calling attention to road safety measure their parents were not taking," says Uma.

Since the school signed up for National Road Safety Mission for



An awareness rally; Uma S. receives the award; and students take the pledge.

Schools in December 2025, they chalked out a series of activities spread across months. The Central Board of Secondary Education had also sent out a circular in January 2026 asking schools to drive programmes as part of Road Safety Month, giving greater impetus to the campaign.

Uma says when taking up such campaigns it is important to involve parents.

"We sent out a circular to parents across classes that the school has signed up for the programme and children are being trained to become road safety ambassadors. Such communication is important

to engage parents, and we had children taking home one message a day," she says.

Traffic rules, pedestrian safety, helmet awareness, seat belt usage, emergency precautions and responsible road behaviour were effectively disseminated through colourful posters, slogan writing competitions, chart presentations, speeches, mime shows, skits, and classroom discussions.

Other highlights include principal Sujatha M administering the Road Safety Oath. Through continuous awareness activities, the school hopes to instil the message on road safety hard.

NPSI demonstrates strong performance in examinations



Abhik Biswas and Adhika Shri Ramesh.

Students of NPS International recorded a good performance in the ICSE (Class X) and ISC (Class XII) examinations for the academic year 2025-26.

In the ISC examinations, the school recorded an overall average of 91.36 percent, says a press release issued by the institution.

Adhika Shri Ramesh emerged as the school topper with 98.25 percent, followed by Advika Satish Pillai with 98 percent and Mridula Kashiram with 97.25 percent.



The class X examination results were equally noteworthy, achieving an average of 90.97 percent.

Abhik Biswas topped with 99.4 percent, followed by B. Sriresh and Purna Suresh with 98.2 percent. R. Kriya, Vidya Harini Pooventhan, and Sivadarshini Shenbagaram secured 97.6 percent. The results reflect consistent effort by students and faculty, alongside the school's sustained focus on holistic, rigorous learning, according to the press release.

Workshop on fundamentals of EV technology

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute is conducting a training programme on electrical vehicle technology from May 13 to 15 at its premises EDII Office Road, SIDCO Industrial Estate in Ekkattuthangal. Time: From 10 a.m. to 5 p.m.

According to a press release, the concepts covered in the workshop include: basics of power electronics, fundamentals of EV bat-

tery, regenerative braking, EV system architecture, electric motors used in EVs, battery management system, thermal management in EVs, EV powertrain operation, safety in EVs, EV performance parameters, basics of EV control systems, EV testing, efficiency and standards, EV applications and case studies, advantages, limitations and challenges of EVs.

For details, call 8668102600 / 8754495254

Workshop on beekeeping

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre, Guindy, is conducting a workshop on beekeeping on May 14. Another workshop on making herbal soaps will be held on May 15. The sessions will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. For details, call 044 - 29530048.

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